

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK Index No.:
COUNTY OF BRONX

**TAHA HAMZA, JAWAD AWAD, ANTHONY AYBAR,
and EDMOND MARTINEZ,** Date Purchased:

Plaintiffs,

– against –

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, DETECTIVE JOE BASSAT, POLICE
OFFICER JOHN DOE AND POLICE OFFICER JOHN
ROE,**

SUMMONS

Plaintiff designates Bronx County as the place of trial. The basis of venue is the action arose in Bronx County.

Defendant(s).

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the Verified Complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiffs' attorney within 20 days after the service of the summons, exclusive of the day of service or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York; and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the notice set forth below and in the within Verified Complaint.

Date: Bronx, New York
July 12, 2018

Richard

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.

Attorney for Plaintiffs
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Bronx, New York 10451
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TO: ZACHARY W. CARTER, ESQ.
Corporation Counsel of City Of New York
100 Church Street
New York, NY 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

DETECTIVE JOE BASSAT (Shield No. 229)
New York City Police Department
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE
New York City Police Department
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE
New York City Police Department
1 Police Plaza
New York, NY 10038

**SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX****TAHA HAMZA, JAWAD AWAD, ANTHONY AYBAR,
and EDMOND MARTINEZ,****INDEX NO.:**

Plaintiffs ,

– against –

VERIFIED COMPLAINT**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, DETECTIVE JOE BASSAT, POLICE
OFFICER JOHN DOE AND POLICE OFFICER JOHN
ROE,**

Defendant(s).

Plaintiffs, by their attorney, **NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.**, complaining of the defendants, respectfully shows to this Court and alleges the following upon information and belief:

1. That at all times the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was and is a resident of Riverside County and State of California.

2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, **CITY OF NEW YORK**, hereinafter referred to as “CITY”, was and still is a municipal corporation organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.

3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, **NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT**, hereinafter referred to as “NYPD”, was and is an agency of the defendant, **CITY**.

4. That on and prior to 1/15/18 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, **DETECTIVE JOE BASSAT** (Shield No. 229), hereinafter referred to as “BASSAT” was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the **CITY** and NYPD.

5. That on and prior to 1/15/18 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant,

POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE, hereinafter referred to as "DOE" was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

6. That on and prior to 1/15/18 and at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendant, POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE, hereinafter referred to as "ROE" was and is a police officer employed by the defendant NYPD, and at all times herein was acting in such capacity as the agent, servant and employee of the CITY and NYPD.

7. Upon information and belief, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., several police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE were on duty and in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

8. Upon information and belief, at all times hereinafter mentioned, and on 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the above mentioned Police Officers were acting within the scope of their employment and under the direction of the CITY and NYPD as its agents, servants and/or employees.

9. Upon information and belief, defendants BASSAT, DOE and ROE were all assigned to Bronx Narcotics.

10. That on and prior to 1/15/18 BASSAT, DOE and ROE were each individually hired, screened, tested, interviewed, trained, retrained, investigated, monitored and supervised by the CITY and NYPD.

11. That on and prior to 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., and all relevant times herein after, BASSAT, DOE and ROE individually and/or collectively were acting pursuant to and under the rules and regulations of the New York City Patrol Guidelines.

12. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York and doing nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway. In point of fact, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was not in possession of any contraband on his person, no contraband was in plain view and Plaintiff was entirely unaware of any contraband on the premises if there were was indeed any at all (which there was not). Moreover, Plaintiff was not the leaseholder nor a resident of any apartment within 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx.

13. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, and based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations, approached Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** for no reason and summarily stopped, frisked, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained him in an aggressive and excessive manner.

14. Upon information and belief BASSAT, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA**.

15. Upon information and belief, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was subjected to a strip search while in the custody of defendants without any legal reason or justification.

16. That Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was arraigned after his arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime or crimes.

17. Thereafter, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against him were terminated favorably.

18. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

19. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimants, the Plaintiff herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimants by the street and number and their attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department,

20. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

21. That the defendants requested an oral examination pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H and same was held.

AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF TAHA HAMZA

22. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 21 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

23. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **TAHA**

HAMZA was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations. and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by BASSAT, DOE and ROE.

24. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** while lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously, intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE of having a crime or crimes.

25. That on or about 1/15/18, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered him on the records as under arrest.

26. That on or about 1/15/18, the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the Courthouse located at 215 East 161st Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

27. That on or about 1/15/18 Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

28. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton,

malicious and grossly negligent manner.

29. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF TAHA HAMZA

30. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 29 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

31. That on or about 1/15/18, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations.

32. That on or about 1/15/18 a criminal action against Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

33. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA'S** life was interfered with.

34. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

35. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

36. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was terminated favorably by dismissal.

37. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

38. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF TAHA HAMZA

39. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 38 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

40. That on or about 1/15/18, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, strip searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

41. That on or about 1/15/18 CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or

menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

42. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and that he was otherwise damaged.

43. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that he was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and he was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

44. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

45. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF TAHA HAMZA

46. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 45 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

47. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, in that said police officers, as employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

48. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test, analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

49. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

50. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and

employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

51. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was injured in mind and body as he was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

52. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

53. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF TAHA HAMZA

54. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-53 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

55. In arresting Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA**, police officers including but not limited to DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

56. In arresting Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA**, police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** or a collateral advantage to

the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

57. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

58. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

59. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF TAHA HAMZA

60. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 59 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

61. That on 1/15/18 , at approximately 1:30 p.m., within the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, the CITY and NYPD were present through its agents, servants and/or employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE who were acting in the course of their employment and under the color of law to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

62. The CITY and NYPD on a consistent and constant basis, have a policy or a program, whether implicit or explicit, that its' agents, employees and others acting under the

direction of defendants including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, with or without a valid search warrant, with or without lawful entry onto private real property or a premises such as an apartment, unlawfully detain, harass, seize, search, destroy and illegally remove personal property and thereafter arrest individuals within such a premises who are neither leaseholders nor owners of said premises (as herein) and who are only present in a room on said real property where contraband is not in plain view.

63. The above must be considered, as the facts herein suggest, when an individual is in a room on a premises where contraband is not in plain view, it cannot be said, as a matter of law, that said individual is to be in actual or constructive possession of contraband nor in possession pursuant to a Penal Law statutory presumption. Nonetheless, defendants on a consistent and constant basis unlawfully stop, seize, search and arrest individuals, such as the Plaintiff herein, in such a scenario even though the stop, seizure and arrest of said individual, including Plaintiff herein, is lacking in reasonable cause, probable cause or legal justification.

64. The foregoing acts, omissions and systemic failures are customs and policies of the CITY and NYPD which caused the police officers herein to falsely arrest, maliciously prosecute, illegally seize and search the Plaintiff unlawfully, commit an assault and battery to Plaintiff's person under the belief that said police officers would not suffer any disciplinary actions for their improper and unconstitutional conduct.

65. The CITY and NYPD'S failure to train its police officers to distinguish between individuals who are lessee's and/or reside at a premises for a sufficient length of time as evidenced by utility bills in their name, letters or mail addressed to them at the premises, as opposed to individuals who are mere guests or visitors who do not have the right to exercise dominion and control over the premises as evidenced by their not having any furniture in the

premises, their name on the lease, their name on a utility bill or mail addressed to them as well as having no personal belongings within the premises that demonstrate something more than a temporary or overnight guest, are all factors that the CITY and NYPD have consistently and constantly ignored in a deliberate and malicious fashion.

66. As the same fact patterns are present over the past several years with alarming frequency, it is apparent and obvious that a pattern by the CITY and NYPD has developed and is in place demonstrating continued violations of individuals similarly situated to the Plaintiff herein. The pattern demonstrates either a defacto policy or custom that exists to allow this behavior by failing to discipline its officers or that this is a custom of its police officers who have no and/or insufficient training and/or no proper supervision and/or disciplinary penalties assessed against them for continued acting in an unconstitutional manner.

67. The below examples demonstrate a small sample of the pattern practice and custom of deliberate indifference by the CITY and NYPD by arresting innocent individuals who are merely present in a location when contraband is not in plain view and have no legal ties to the premises being searched either with or without a search warrant, either legally or illegally.

a. On 10/22/10, Joanne BROWN, Andrea Doby and Tameka Gunter were inside apartment 4E at 1684 Nelson Avenue, Bronx, NY. They were doing nothing illegal or improper and were simply visiting a friend. None of the aforementioned individuals were leaseholders or had any legal connections to the premises. All 3 individuals were only in the apartment for a short while when all of a sudden several police officers entered the apartment and arrested all of the occupants. Despite several requests the officers never presented a search warrant. All 3 of the above-mentioned individuals were charged with possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree despite the fact that none of them ever were aware of or had any knowledge of

any contraband in the apartment and contraband was not in plain view at anytime. All charges were eventually dismissed.

b. On 2/8/08, Tony Mizell was inside apartment 2 at 950 Saint John Avenue, Bronx, NY. Mr. Mizell was not a leaseholder of said premises and had no legal connection to the apartment. He was simply an overnight guest with his wife and small child. All of a sudden, in the early morning hours, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested all of the occupants for possession of a weapon. A search warrant was never presented. The weapon was located in a back bedroom inside a closet within a coat pocket. Mr. Mizell had no connection to the gun, the bedroom or the closet. He was arrested and prosecuted for several months even though the owner of the gun pled guilty in Federal Court shortly after 2/8/08. Eventually all charges were dismissed against Mr. Mizell.

c. On 1/10/10 Gregory Jacobus was inside apartment 4 located at 2290 Davidson Avenue, Bronx, New York. Mr. Jacobus was visiting his chess teacher. He was simply an overnight guest in apartment 4 and was not a leaseholder and had no legal rights to the apartment. Early in the morning while Mr. Jacobus was in the shower, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Mr. Jacobus and his chess teacher. A search warrant was never presented. Mr. Jacobus never saw any contraband in the apartment at anytime and had no knowledge of any contraband if there was indeed any. After spending several days in jail, a Grand Jury dismissed all charges against Mr. Jacobus.

d. On 6/12/07 Joanne Reyes was inside apartment 1F at 1530 Sheridan Ave, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours Ms. Reyes heard a loud bang and several people rushed into her apartment. Ms. Reyes thought she was getting robbed until she realized the individuals were police officers. Even though Ms. Reyes was not a leaseholder to the apartment and no

contraband was in plain view at anytime and Ms. Reyes never saw any contraband within the apartment at anytime, she was handcuffed, arrested and taken to a local precinct and then central booking. Her pleas for her medications were summarily ignored throughout the entire time she was detained. After being prosecuted for several months the case was eventually dismissed.

e. On 4/4/08 Shakenia Garlick was inside apartment 7B at 2487 Grand Avenue, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours several police officers broke down the front door and entered her apartment. No search warrant was ever presented. Ms. Garlick had no knowledge of any contraband in the apartment and same was never in plain view. Despite aggressive questioning by the officers Ms. Garlick insisted that they were making a mistake and were, perhaps, in the wrong apartment. She was arrested for possession of a controlled substance. The substance was her pre-natal vitamins. The case was dismissed by the District Attorney's Office when the laboratory analysis indicated negative for a controlled substance.

f. On 8/5/09 Edward Benitez was inside apartment 5E visiting his friend at 894 Rogers Place. It was the early afternoon and Mr. Benitez was inside the apartment for only a few minutes. All of a sudden there was a knock at the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Despite the fact that Mr. Benitez was not a resident of the apartment, not a leaseholder and had no legal connection to the apartment he was arrested for possession of marihuana which was neither on his person or in plain view in any part of the apartment. After several court appearances all charges were dismissed against him.

g. On 1/18/12 Jennifer Tarantino was inside apartment E1N at 3034 Grand Concourse, Bronx, NY. She was visiting her boyfriend who was renting out the spare bedroom to another individual. Around 10:00 p.m. Ms. Tarantino was awoken by a loud noise and several police officers were pointing their guns at her as she lie in bed. Even though Ms. Tarantino was not a

leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to the apartment she, as an overnight guest, was arrested and charged with possession of a controlled substance in the third degree. She was never presented with a search warrant despite numerous requests and never saw anything illegal in plain view. All charges against her were eventually dismissed.

h. On 11/18/11 Sabrina Souffront was in apartment 4A located at 1465 Washington Ave, Bronx, NY. Ms. Souffront was visiting a friend and was not a leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to said apartment. No contraband was ever in plain view and she had no knowledge of any contraband within the apartment. In the early morning hours, Ms. Souffront heard a loud bang at the front door and several police officers rushed into the apartment and detained all of the occupants. Ms. Souffront later learned that in one of the bedrooms, within a closet, was a small amount of narcotics. Ms. Souffront was completely unaware of the existence of anything illegal in the apartment and in fact was never even in that particular bedroom during her visit. She was arrested and held in jail for over 24 hours. Eventually all charges against her were dismissed.

i. On 7/29/11 Ismael Velez and Michael Concepcion were inside the basement apartment at 512 East 162nd Street, Bronx, NY. The basement apartment was a music studio and Velez and Concepcion were recording. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden, several police officers rushed into the studio and assaulted Velez and Concepcion and arrested them for possession of marihuana. Velez and Concepcion were not leaseholders and had no legal ties to the basement apartment. In addition, Velez and Concepcion never saw any illegal substances in plain view at anytime they were in the recording studio. All charges were eventually dismissed.

j. On 6/17/10 Samantha Morales was inside apartment 5B located at 1000 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into

the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales and all of the occupants. Ms. Morales was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with possession of marihuana even though marihuana was never found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute Ms. Morales.

k. On 6/16/10 Coty Morales was inside apartment 4K at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Morales is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

l. On 6/16/10 Christopher Hernandez was inside apartment 4H at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Hernandez is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

m. On 2/1/12 Hector Figueroa, Sr., Hector Figueroa, Jr. and Laurita Figueroa were inside apartment 6A at 360 Morris Avenue, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours they heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. The police broke Mr. Figueroa, Sr.'s nose (he is approximately 74 years old). All were arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the

apartment and in point of fact no contraband was ever in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

n. On 2/28/14, Damario Morales and Robert Lopez, Jr., were exiting the basement apartment of 766 Union Avenue when all of a sudden several police officers rushed towards them and pushed and pulled them into the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales, Mr. Lopez and all of the occupants of the basement apartment. Neither Ms. Morales nor Mr. Lopez were the leaseholder of the apartment. Both were charged with possession of a controlled substance even though no narcotics were ever found and certainly none were in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed both cases.

o. On 7/16/15 Fantasia Jenkins was inside apartment 8D located at 595 Trinity Avenue, Bronx, NY. Ms. Jenkins was simply an overnight guest in the apartment. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Ms. Jenkins and all of the occupants. Ms. Jenkins was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Ms. Jenkins spent 9 days in custody. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed Ms. Jenkins' case.

p. On 11/20/14 Jamel McNeil and Magan Paulino were inside a757 St. Anns Avenue, Bronx, NY. Both Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino were simply overnight guests in the house. In the late morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the house and arrested Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino and all of the occupants. Mr. McNeil nor Ms. Paulino were

leaseholders, owners or renters of the house but only overnight guests. They were charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed both cases.

68. As is evidenced from the above, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA'S** injuries including the violation of his constitutional rights, the deprivation of his freedom, falsely and maliciously being prosecuted, physical and emotional injuries, are the direct and proximate result of the CITY'S and NYPD'S policies and/or deliberate indifference to practices which involve the excessive use of force, false arrest, police cover-ups, witness intimidation, malicious prosecution, illegal stop, questions and frisks, strip searches, Fourth Amendment violations, and deliberate indifference to the need to train, supervise, monitor, investigate and discipline, including suspension, dismissal and/or reassignment offending police officers.

69. Moreover, it is the direct result of police officers arresting individuals for possession of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder. The practice is widespread and pervasive throughout the entire City of New York.

70. The CITY and NYPD knew or should have known of the customs and police practices of its officers which included but was not limited to: the failing to preserve and/or destruction of exculpatory evidence, threatening to arrest witnesses to police misconduct and engaging in cover-ups, fraud, perjury, deceit and malfeasance, arresting individuals when not in possession of a valid search warrant as well as police officers arresting individuals for possession

of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder.

71. That the acts of employees of the CITY and NYPD, i.e. police officers, who violate the civil and constitutional rights of the citizens of the City of New York routinely go unreported, undisciplined and their acts condoned by other officers, including their supervisors. Upon information and belief, the supervisors of defendant police officers herein were aware of the conduct of defendant police officers and failed to stop, report or intervene in the misconduct.

72. The CITY and NYPD'S tolerance for brutality, excessive force, illegal and/or retaliatory arrests, and their emphasis to come down hard on quality of life infractions leads to a systemic practice and policy wherein police officers seem fairly tolerant of police brutality, silence in the face of brutality and/or illegal stops, frisks, searches, seizures and/or arrests, and engage in the practice of meeting arrest quotas. A systemic practice where officers who report said misconduct are not viewed as "good cops" but rather as outcasts and are ostracized and often transferred to other assignments thereby perpetuating the illegal conduct of the NYPD and thusly the CITY.

73. Some instances where officers were treated as outcasts for reporting misconduct and/or arrest/summons quota system are as follows:

a. The existence of arrest quotas, summons quotas and approval of illegal stops and arrests have been exposed by Police officer Adrian Schoolcraft in a separate lawsuit which was cited by Justice Sheindlin in Floyd.

b. Justice Sheindlin referenced the deposition of Police Officer Polanco of the 41st

Precinct stating that commanding officers set specific quotas for arrests and summons and for stop and frisks and threatened to reduce overtime for officers who failed to perform well and re-assign those who fail to meet quotas to less desirable posts.

c. According to secretly tape recorded conversations made by Schoolcraft, a Lieutenant, a Deputy Inspector and Chief of Transportation can be heard encouraging and demanding increased stops, summons and detentions and arrests.

d. Police Officer Craig Kathleens of the 42nd Precinct filed a lawsuit against the NYPD claiming the existence of a quota system and a systematic retaliation and harassment to those who did not comply.

e. Retired Detective James Griffin filed a lawsuit claiming that in the NYPD there exists a culture wherein officers who report corruption will face harassment and a hostile work environment and that this conduct was tolerated by supervisors within the NYPD.

f. Police Officer Anthony Minoia, an officer with an Ivy League degree, assigned to the 42nd Precinct, was reassigned to a "punishment post" due to the fact that he failed to write a sufficient amount of summons and stated "I'm not going to pull out my summons book and write a summons because my boss is telling me he's going to make it difficult for me if I don't."

74. In sum, the CITY and NYPD are responsible for creating a custom, policy or practice wherein many officers do not seem to believe that anything is really wrong with stopping and searching innocent citizens or using unnecessary or excessive force or falsely arresting citizens to meet an arrest quota.

75. That the above customs, policies and/or practices and the deliberate indifference thereto, was a direct and proximate cause of the illegal seizure of Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA**, the excessive use of force on Plaintiff, and the false arrest and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff.

The CITY and NYPD'S polices, customs and/or practices deprived the Plaintiff of his rights and liberties as set forth in the Constitutions of the United States and the State of New York and under 42 U.S.C §§ 1983, 1986 and 1988.

76. That said actions violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, violated Plaintiff's right to be secure in person, and that the defendants used excessive, unnecessary and unlawful force, which constituted cruel and inhumane treatment and denied him due process of law.

77. Moreover, the CITY and NYPD caused or created a policy and/or custom, and acted with deliberate indifference to patterns and/or police practices which included illegal seizures, excessive or arbitrary use of force, illegal use of police equipment, destruction of evidence, intimidation of witnesses, illegal arrests, failing to gather evidence when allegations of police misconduct are involved, condoning a code of silence within the NYPD regarding misconduct, failing to take police reports of illegal conduct, failing to properly supervise, train, investigate or discipline officers, and any and/or all of the above have contributed to Plaintiff's false arrest, malicious and false prosecution, and injuries.

78. That the Plaintiff did not commit any illegal act, either before or at the time he was falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted, battered and deprived of him constitutional rights as set forth in the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C § 1983.

79. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF TAHA HAMZA

80. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 79 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

81. At all times mentioned herein and above, defendants CITY and NYPD employed BASSAT, DOE and ROE as police officers and named defendants were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

82. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Riverside County in the State of California and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

83. That on or about 1/15/18, defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and strip searched and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

84. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE and ROE resulted in Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to

his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process; and g) The right to Due Process of Law.

85. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, monitor, supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

86. Defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE subjected Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional, grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA'S** rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the United States Constitution.

87. The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

88. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF JAWAD AWAD

89. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every

allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 88 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

90. That at all times the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was and is a resident of Hudson County and State of New Jersey.

91. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York and doing nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway. In point of fact, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was not in possession of any contraband on his person, no contraband was in plain view and Plaintiff was entirely unaware of any contraband on the premises if there were was indeed any at all (which there was not). Moreover, Plaintiff was not the leaseholder nor a resident of any apartment within 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx.

92. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, approached Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** for no reason and summarily stopped, frisked, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained him in an aggressive and excessive manner.

93. Upon information and belief BASSAT, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD**.

94. Upon information and belief, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was subjected to a strip search while in the custody of defendants without any legal reason or justification.

95. That Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was arraigned after his arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime or crimes.

96. Thereafter, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against him were terminated favorably.

97. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

98. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimants, the Plaintiff herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimants by the street and number and their attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department.

99. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

100. That the defendants requested an oral examination pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H and same was held.

101. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized

and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by BASSAT, DOE and ROE.

102. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** while lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously, intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE of having committed a crime or crimes.

103. That on or about 1/15/18, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered him on the records as under arrest.

104. That on or about 1/15/18, the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the Courthouse located at 215 East 161st Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

105. That on or about 1/15/18 Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

106. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

107. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF JAWAD AWAD

108. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 107 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

109. That on or about 1/15/18, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations.

110. That on or about 1/15/18 a criminal action against Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

111. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD'S** life was interfered with.

112. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

113. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

114. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was terminated

favorably by dismissal.

115. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

116. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF JAWAD AWAD

117. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 116 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

118. That on or about 1/15/18, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, strip searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

119. That on or about 1/15/18 CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner

touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

120. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and that she was otherwise damaged.

121. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that she was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and she was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

122. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

123. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF JAWAD AWAD

124. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 123 with the same force and effect as if fully set

forth at length herein.

125. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE in that said police officers, as employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

126. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test, analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

127. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

128. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

129. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was injured in mind and body as he was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

130. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

131. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF JAWAD AWAD

132. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-131 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

133. In arresting Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD**, police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

134. In arresting Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD**, police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

135. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

136. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all

defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

137. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF JAWAD AWAD

138. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 137 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

139. That on 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., within the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, the CITY and NYPD were present through its agents, servants and/or employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE who were acting in the course of their employment and under the color of law to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

140. The CITY and NYPD on a consistent and constant basis, have a policy or a program, whether implicit or explicit, that its' agents, employees and others acting under the direction of defendants including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, with or without a valid search warrant, with or without lawful entry onto private real property or a premises such as an apartment, unlawfully detain, harass, seize, search, destroy and illegally remove personal property and thereafter arrest individuals within such a premises who are neither leaseholders nor owners of said premises (as herein) and who are only present in a room on said real property

where contraband is not in plain view.

141. The above must be considered, as the facts herein suggest, when an individual is in a room on a premises where contraband is not in plain view, it cannot be said, as a matter of law, that said individual is to be in actual or constructive possession of contraband nor in possession pursuant to a Penal Law statutory presumption. Nonetheless, defendants on a consistent and constant basis unlawfully stop, seize, search and arrest individuals, such as the Plaintiff herein, in such a scenario even though the stop, seizure and arrest of said individual, including Plaintiff herein, is lacking in reasonable cause, probable cause or legal justification.

142. The foregoing acts, omissions and systemic failures are customs and policies of the CITY and NYPD which caused the police officers herein to falsely arrest, maliciously prosecute, illegally seize and search the Plaintiff unlawfully, commit an assault and battery to Plaintiff's person under the belief that said police officers would not suffer any disciplinary actions for their improper and unconstitutional conduct.

143. The CITY and NYPD'S failure to train its police officers to distinguish between individuals who are lessee's and/or reside at a premises for a sufficient length of time as evidenced by utility bills in their name, letters or mail addressed to them at the premises, as opposed to individuals who are mere guests or visitors who do not have the right to exercise dominion and control over the premises as evidenced by their not having any furniture in the premises, their name on the lease, their name on a utility bill or mail addressed to them as well as having no personal belongings within the premises that demonstrate something more than a temporary or overnight guest, are all factors that the CITY and NYPD have consistently and constantly ignored in a deliberate and malicious fashion.

144. As the same fact patterns are present over the past several years with alarming

frequency, it is apparent and obvious that a pattern by the CITY and NYPD has developed and is in place demonstrating continued violations of individuals similarly situated to the Plaintiff herein. The pattern demonstrates either a defacto policy or custom that exists to allow this behavior by failing to discipline its officers or that this is a custom of its police officers who have no and/or insufficient training and/or no proper supervision and/or disciplinary penalties assessed against them for continued acting in an unconstitutional manner.

145. The below examples demonstrate a small sample of the pattern practice and custom of deliberate indifference by the CITY and NYPD by arresting innocent individuals who are merely present in a location when contraband is not in plain view and have no legal ties to the premises being searched either with or without a search warrant, either legally or illegally.

a. On 10/22/10, Joanne BROWN, Andrea Doby and Tameka Gunter were inside apartment 4E at 1684 Nelson Avenue, Bronx, NY. They were doing nothing illegal or improper and were simply visiting a friend. None of the aforementioned individuals were leaseholders or had any legal connections to the premises. All 3 individuals were only in the apartment for a short while when all of a sudden several police officers entered the apartment and arrested all of the occupants. Despite several requests the officers never presented a search warrant. All 3 of the above-mentioned individuals were charged with possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree despite the fact that none of them ever were aware of or had any knowledge of any contraband in the apartment and contraband was not in plain view at anytime. All charges were eventually dismissed.

b. On 2/8/08, Tony Mizell was inside apartment 2 at 950 Saint John Avenue, Bronx, NY. Mr. Mizell was not a leaseholder of said premises and had no legal connection to the apartment. He was simply an overnight guest with his wife and small child. All of a sudden, in

the early morning hours, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested all of the occupants for possession of a weapon. A search warrant was never presented. The weapon was located in a back bedroom inside a closet within a coat pocket. Mr. Mizell had no connection to the gun, the bedroom or the closet. He was arrested and prosecuted for several months even though the owner of the gun pled guilty in Federal Court shortly after 2/8/08. Eventually all charges were dismissed against Mr. Mizell.

c. On 1/10/10 Gregory Jacobus was inside apartment 4 located at 2290 Davidson Avenue, Bronx, New York. Mr. Jacobus was visiting his chess teacher. He was simply an overnight guest in apartment 4 and was not a leaseholder and had no legal rights to the apartment. Early in the morning while Mr. Jacobus was in the shower, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Mr. Jacobus and his chess teacher. A search warrant was never presented. Mr. Jacobus never saw any contraband in the apartment at anytime and had no knowledge of any contraband if there was indeed any. After spending several days in jail, a Grand Jury dismissed all charges against Mr. Jacobus.

d. On 6/12/07 Joanne Reyes was inside apartment 1F at 1530 Sheridan Ave, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours Ms. Reyes heard a loud bang and several people rushed into her apartment. Ms. Reyes thought she was getting robbed until she realized the individuals were police officers. Even though Ms. Reyes was not a leaseholder to the apartment and no contraband was in plain view at anytime and Ms. Reyes never saw any contraband within the apartment at anytime, she was handcuffed, arrested and taken to a local precinct and then central booking. Her pleas for her medications were summarily ignored throughout the entire time she was detained. After being prosecuted for several months the case was eventually dismissed.

e. On 4/4/08 Shakenia Garlick was inside apartment 7B at 2487 Grand Avenue,

Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours several police officers broke down the front door and entered her apartment. No search warrant was ever presented. Ms. Garlic had no knowledge of any contraband in the apartment and same was never in plain view. Despite aggressive questioning by the officers Ms. Garlic insisted that they were making a mistake and were, perhaps, in the wrong apartment. She was arrested for possession of a controlled substance. The substance was her pre-natal vitamins. The case was dismissed by the District Attorney's Office when the laboratory analysis indicated negative for a controlled substance.

f. On 8/5/09 Edward Benitez was inside apartment 5E visiting his friend at 894 Rogers Place. It was the early afternoon and Mr. Benitez was inside the apartment for only a few minutes. All of a sudden there was a knock at the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Despite the fact that Mr. Bentiez was not a resident of the apartment, not a leaseholder and had no legal connection to the apartment he was arrested for possession of marihuana which was neither on his person or in plain view in any part of the apartment. After several court appearances all charges were dismissed against him

g. On 1/18/12 Jennifer Tarantino was inside apartment E1N at 3034 Grand Concourse, Bronx, NY. She was visiting her boyfriend who was renting out the spare bedroom to another individual. Around 10:00 p.m. Ms. Tarantino was awoken by a loud noise and several police officers were pointing their guns at her as she lie in bed. Even though Ms. Tarantino was not a leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to the apartment she, as an overnight guest, was arrested and charged with possession of a controlled substance in the third degree. She was never presented with a search warrant despite numerous requests and never saw anything illegal in plain view. All charges against her were eventually dismissed.

h. On 11/18/11 Sabrina Souffront was in apartment 4A located at 1465 Washington

Ave, Bronx, NY. Ms. Souffront was visiting a friend and was not a leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to said apartment. No contraband was ever in plain view and she had no knowledge of any contraband within the apartment. In the early morning hours, Ms. Souffront heard a loud bang at the front door and several police officers rushed into the apartment and detained all of the occupants. Ms. Souffront later learned that in one of the bedrooms, within a closet, was a small amount of narcotics. Ms. Souffront was completely unaware of the existence of anything illegal in the apartment and in fact was never even in that particular bedroom during her visit. She was arrested and held in jail for over 24 hours. Eventually all charges against her were dismissed.

i. On 7/29/11 Ismael Velez and Michael Concepcion were inside the basement apartment at 512 East 162nd Street, Bronx, NY. The basement apartment was a music studio and Velez and Concepcion were recording. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden, several police officers rushed into the studio and assaulted Velez and Concepcion and arrested them for possession of marihuana. Velez and Concepcion were not leaseholders and had no legal ties to the basement apartment. In addition, Velez and Concepcion never saw any illegal substances in plain view at anytime they were in the recording studio. All charges were eventually dismissed.

j. On 6/17/10 Samantha Morales was inside apartment 5B located at 1000 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales and all of the occupants. Ms. Morales was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with possession of marihuana even though marihuana was never found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute Ms. Morales.

k. On 6/16/10 Coty Morales was inside apartment 4K at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Morales is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

l. On 6/16/10 Christopher Hernandez was inside apartment 4H at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Hernandez is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

m. On 2/1/12 Hector Figueroa, Sr., Hector Figueroa, Jr. and Laurita Figueroa were inside apartment 6A at 360 Morris Avenue, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours they heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. The police broke Mr. Figueroa, Sr.'s nose (he is approximately 74 years old). All were arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment and in point of fact no contraband was ever in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

n. On 2/28/14, Damario Morales and Robert Lopez, Jr., were exiting the basement apartment of 766 Union Avenue when all of a sudden several police officers rushed towards

them and pushed and pulled them into the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales, Mr. Lopez and all of the occupants of the basement apartment. Neither Ms. Morales nor Mr. Lopez were the leaseholder of the apartment. Both were charged with possession of a controlled substance even though no narcotics were ever found and certainly none were in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed both cases.

o. On 7/16/15 Fantasia Jenkins was inside apartment 8D located at 595 Trinity Avenue, Bronx, NY. Ms. Jenkins was simply an overnight guest in the apartment. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Ms. Jenkins and all of the occupants. Ms. Jenkins was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Ms. Jenkins spent 9 days in custody. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed Ms. Jenkins' case.

p. On 11/20/14 Jamel McNeil and Magan Paulino were inside a757 St. Anns Avenue, Bronx, NY. Both Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino were simply overnight guests in the house. In the late morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the house and arrested Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino and all of the occupants. Mr. McNeil nor Ms. Paulino were leaseholders, owners or renters of the house but only overnight guests. They were charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed both cases.

146. As is evidenced from the above, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD'S** injuries including the

violation of his constitutional rights, the deprivation of his freedom, falsely and maliciously being prosecuted, physical and emotional injuries, are the direct and proximate result of the CITY'S and NYPD'S policies and/or deliberate indifference to practices which involve the excessive use of force, false arrest, police cover-ups, witness intimidation, malicious prosecution, illegal stop, questions and frisks, strip searches, Fourth Amendment violations, and deliberate indifference to the need to train, supervise, monitor, investigate and discipline, including suspension, dismissal and/or reassignment offending police officers.

147. Moreover, it is the direct result of police officers arresting individuals for possession of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder. The practice is widespread and pervasive throughout the entire City of New York.

148. The CITY and NYPD knew or should have known of the customs and police practices of its officers which included but was not limited to: the failing to preserve and/or destruction of exculpatory evidence, threatening to arrest witnesses to police misconduct and engaging in cover-ups, fraud, perjury, deceit and malfeasance, arresting individuals when not in possession of a valid search warrant as well as police officers arresting individuals for possession of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder.

149. That the acts of employees of the CITY and NYPD, i.e. police officers, who violate

the civil and constitutional rights of the citizens of the City of New York routinely go unreported, undisciplined and their acts condoned by other officers, including their supervisors. Upon information and belief, the supervisors of defendant police officers herein were aware of the conduct of defendant police officers and failed to stop, report or intervene in the misconduct.

150. The CITY and NYPD'S tolerance for brutality, excessive force, illegal and/or retaliatory arrests, and their emphasis to come down hard on quality of life infractions leads to a systemic practice and policy wherein police officers seem fairly tolerant of police brutality, silence in the face of brutality and/or illegal stops, frisks, searches, seizures and/or arrests, and engage in the practice of meeting arrest quotas. A systemic practice where officers who report said misconduct are not viewed as "good cops" but rather as outcasts and are ostracized and often transferred to other assignments thereby perpetuating the illegal conduct of the NYPD and thusly the CITY.

151. Some instances where officers were treated as outcasts for reporting misconduct and/or arrest/summons quota system are as follows:

a. The existence of arrest quotas, summons quotas and approval of illegal stops and arrests have been exposed by Police officer Adrian Schoolcraft in a separate lawsuit which was cited by Justice Sheindlin in Floyd.

b. Justice Sheindlin referenced the deposition of Police Officer Polanco of the 41st Precinct stating that commanding officers set specific quotas for arrests and summons and for stop and frisks and threatened to reduce overtime for officers who failed to perform well and re-assign those who fail to meet quotas to less desirable posts.

c. According to secretly tape recorded conversations made by Schoolcraft, a Lieutenant, a Deputy Inspector and Chief of Transportation can be heard encouraging and

demanding increased stops, summons and detentions and arrests.

d. Police Officer Craig Kathleens of the 42nd Precinct filed a lawsuit against the NYPD claiming the existence of a quota system and a systematic retaliation and harassment to those who did not comply.

e. Retired Detective James Griffin filed a lawsuit claiming that in the NYPD there exists a culture wherein officers who report corruption will face harassment and a hostile work environment and that this conduct was tolerated by supervisors within the NYPD.

f. Police Officer Anthony Minoia, an officer with an Ivy League degree, assigned to the 42nd Precinct, was reassigned to a “punishment post” due to the fact that he failed to write a sufficient amount of summons and stated “I’m not going to pull out my summons book and write a summons because my boss is telling me he’s going to make it difficult for me if I don’t.”

152. In sum, the CITY and NYPD are responsible for creating a custom, policy or practice wherein many officers do not seem to believe that anything is really wrong with stopping and searching innocent citizens or using unnecessary or excessive force or falsely arresting citizens to meet an arrest quota.

153. That the above customs, policies and/or practices and the deliberate indifference thereto, was a direct and proximate cause of the illegal seizure of Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD**, the excessive use of force on Plaintiff, and the false arrest and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff. The CITY and NYPD’S policies, customs and/or practices deprived the Plaintiff of his rights and liberties as set forth in the Constitutions of the United States and the State of New York and under 42 U.S.C §§ 1983, 1986 and 1988.

154. That said actions violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, violated Plaintiff’s right to be secure in person, and that the

defendants used excessive, unnecessary and unlawful force, which constituted cruel and inhumane treatment and denied him due process of law.

155. Moreover, the CITY and NYPD caused or created a policy and/or custom, and acted with deliberate indifference to patterns and/or police practices which included illegal seizures, excessive or arbitrary use of force, illegal use of police equipment, destruction of evidence, intimidation of witnesses, illegal arrests, failing to gather evidence when allegations of police misconduct are involved, condoning a code of silence within the NYPD regarding misconduct, failing to take police reports of illegal conduct, failing to properly supervise, train, investigate or discipline officers, and any and/or all of the above have contributed to Plaintiff's false arrest, malicious and false prosecution, and injuries.

156. That the Plaintiff did not commit any illegal act, either before or at the time he was falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted, battered and deprived of his constitutional rights as set forth in the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C § 1983.

157. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF JAWAD AWAD

158. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 157 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

159. At all times mentioned herein and above, defendants CITY and NYPD employed BASSAT, DOE and ROE as police officers and named defendants were acting under color of

law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

160. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Hudson County in the State of New Jersey and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

161. That on or about 1/15/18, defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and strip searched and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

162. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE resulted in Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process; and g) The right to Due Process of Law.

163. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, monitor,

supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

164. Defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE subjected Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional, grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD'S** rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the United States Constitution.

165. The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

166. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF ANTHONY AYBAR

167. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 166 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

168. That at all times the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was and is a resident of County of the Bronx, City and State of New York.

169. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York and doing

nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway. In point of fact, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was not in possession of any contraband on her person, no contraband was in plain view and Plaintiff was entirely unaware of any contraband on the premises if there were indeed any at all (which there was not). Moreover, Plaintiff was not the leaseholder nor a resident of any apartment within 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx.

170. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, approached Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** for no reason and summarily stopped, frisked, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained her in an aggressive and excessive manner.

171. Upon information and belief BASSAT, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR**.

172. Upon information and belief, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was subjected to a strip search while in the custody of defendants without any legal reason or justification.

173. That Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was arraigned after her arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime or crimes.

174. Thereafter, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against her were terminated favorably.

175. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

176. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more

than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimants, the Plaintiff herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimants by the street and number and their attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department,

177. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

178. That the defendants requested an oral examination pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H and same was held.

179. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by BASSAT, DOE and ROE.

180. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** while lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously, intentionally

and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE of having committed a crime or crimes.

181. That on or about 1/15/18, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered him on the records as under arrest.

182. That on or about 1/15/18, the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the Courthouse located at 215 East 161st Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

183. That on or about 1/15/18 Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

184. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

185. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SIXTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF ANTHONY AYBAR

186. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every

allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 185 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

187. That on or about 1/15/18, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations.

188. That on or about 1/15/18 a criminal action against Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

189. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR'S** life was interfered with.

190. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

191. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

192. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was terminated favorably by dismissal.

193. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

194. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A SEVENTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF ANTHONY AYBAR

195. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 195 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

196. That on or about 1/15/18, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of the Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, strip searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

197. That on or about 1/15/18 CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

198. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the

scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and that he was otherwise damaged.

199. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that he was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and he was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

200. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

201. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A EIGHTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF ANTHONY AYBAR

202. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 201 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

203. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, in that said police officers, as employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or

promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

204. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test, analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

205. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

206. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

207. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was injured in mind and body as she was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

208. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

209. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A NINETEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF ANTHONY AYBAR

210 Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-209 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

211. In arresting Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR**, police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

212. In arresting Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR**, police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

213. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

214. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

215. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TWENTIETH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF ANTHONY AYBAR

216. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 215 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

217. That on 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., within the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, the CITY and NYPD were present through its agents, servants and/or employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE who were acting in the course of their employment and under the color of law to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

218. The CITY and NYPD on a consistent and constant basis, have a policy or a program, whether implicit or explicit, that its' agents, employees and others acting under the direction of defendants including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, with or without a valid search warrant, with or without lawful entry onto private real property or a premises such as an apartment, unlawfully detain, harass, seize, search, destroy and illegally remove personal property and thereafter arrest individuals within such a premises who are neither leaseholders nor owners of said premises (as herein) and who are only present in a room on said real property where contraband is not in plain view.

219. The above must be considered, as the facts herein suggest, when an individual is in a room on a premises where contraband is not in plain view, it cannot be said, as a matter of law, that said individual is to be in actual or constructive possession of contraband nor in possession pursuant to a Penal Law statutory presumption. Nonetheless, defendants on a consistent and

constant basis unlawfully stop, seize, search and arrest individuals, such as the Plaintiff herein, in such a scenario even though the stop, seizure and arrest of said individual, including Plaintiff herein, is lacking in reasonable cause, probable cause or legal justification.

220. The foregoing acts, omissions and systemic failures are customs and policies of the CITY and NYPD which caused the police officers herein to falsely arrest, maliciously prosecute, illegally seize and search the Plaintiff unlawfully, commit an assault and battery to Plaintiff's person under the belief that said police officers would not suffer any disciplinary actions for their improper and unconstitutional conduct.

221. The CITY and NYPD'S failure to train its police officers to distinguish between individuals who are lessee's and/or reside at a premises for a sufficient length of time as evidenced by utility bills in their name, letters or mail addressed to them at the premises, as opposed to individuals who are mere guests or visitors who do not have the right to exercise dominion and control over the premises as evidenced by their not having any furniture in the premises, their name on the lease, their name on a utility bill or mail addressed to them as well as having no personal belongings within the premises that demonstrate something more than a temporary or overnight guest, are all factors that the CITY and NYPD have consistently and constantly ignored in a deliberate and malicious fashion.

222. As the same fact patterns are present over the past several years with alarming frequency, it is apparent and obvious that a pattern by the CITY and NYPD has developed and is in place demonstrating continued violations of individuals similarly situated to the Plaintiff herein. The pattern demonstrates either a defacto policy or custom that exists to allow this behavior by failing to discipline its officers or that this is a custom of its police officers who have no and/or insufficient training and/or no proper supervision and/or disciplinary penalties assessed

against them for continued acting in an unconstitutional manner.

223. The below examples demonstrate a small sample of the pattern practice and custom of deliberate indifference by the CITY and NYPD by arresting innocent individuals who are merely present in a location when contraband is not in plain view and have no legal ties to the premises being searched either with or without a search warrant, either legally or illegally.

a. On 10/22/10, Joanne BROWN, Andrea Doby and Tameka Gunter were inside apartment 4E at 1684 Nelson Avenue, Bronx, NY. They were doing nothing illegal or improper and were simply visiting a friend. None of the aforementioned individuals were leaseholders or had any legal connections to the premises. All 3 individuals were only in the apartment for a short while when all of a sudden several police officers entered the apartment and arrested all of the occupants. Despite several requests the officers never presented a search warrant. All 3 of the above-mentioned individuals were charged with possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree despite the fact that none of them ever were aware of or had any knowledge of any contraband in the apartment and contraband was not in plain view at anytime. All charges were eventually dismissed.

b. On 2/8/08, Tony Mizell was inside apartment 2 at 950 Saint John Avenue, Bronx, NY. Mr. Mizell was not a leaseholder of said premises and had no legal connection to the apartment. He was simply an overnight guest with his wife and small child. All of a sudden, in the early morning hours, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested all of the occupants for possession of a weapon. A search warrant was never presented. The weapon was located in a back bedroom inside a closet within a coat pocket. Mr. Mizell had no connection to the gun, the bedroom or the closet. He was arrested and prosecuted for several months even though the owner of the gun pled guilty in Federal Court shortly after 2/8/08. Eventually all

charges were dismissed against Mr. Mizell.

c. On 1/10/10 Gregory Jacobus was inside apartment 4 located at 2290 Davidson Avenue, Bronx, New York. Mr. Jacobus was visiting his chess teacher. He was simply an overnight guest in apartment 4 and was not a leaseholder and had no legal rights to the apartment. Early in the morning while Mr. Jacobus was in the shower, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Mr. Jacobus and his chess teacher. A search warrant was never presented. Mr. Jacobus never saw any contraband in the apartment at anytime and had no knowledge of any contraband if there was indeed any. After spending several days in jail, a Grand Jury dismissed all charges against Mr. Jacobus.

d. On 6/12/07 Joanne Reyes was inside apartment 1F at 1530 Sheridan Ave, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours Ms. Reyes heard a loud bang and several people rushed into her apartment. Ms. Reyes thought she was getting robbed until she realized the individuals were police officers. Even though Ms. Reyes was not a leaseholder to the apartment and no contraband was in plain view at anytime and Ms. Reyes never saw any contraband within the apartment at anytime, she was handcuffed, arrested and taken to a local precinct and then central booking. Her pleas for her medications were summarily ignored throughout the entire time she was detained. After being prosecuted for several months the case was eventually dismissed.

e. On 4/4/08 Shakenia Garlick was inside apartment 7B at 2487 Grand Avenue, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours several police officers broke down the front door and entered her apartment. No search warrant was ever presented. Ms. Garlick had no knowledge of any contraband in the apartment and same was never in plain view. Despite aggressive questioning by the officers Ms. Garlick insisted that they were making a mistake and were, perhaps, in the wrong apartment. She was arrested for possession of a controlled substance. The

substance was her pre-natal vitamins. The case was dismissed by the District Attorney's Office when the laboratory analysis indicated negative for a controlled substance.

f. On 8/5/09 Edward Benitez was inside apartment 5E visiting his friend at 894 Rogers Place. It was the early afternoon and Mr. Benitez was inside the apartment for only a few minutes. All of a sudden there was a knock at the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Despite the fact that Mr. Bentiez was not a resident of the apartment, not a leaseholder and had no legal connection to the apartment he was arrested for possession of marihuana which was neither on his person or in plain view in any part of the apartment. After several court appearances all charges were dismissed against him

g. On 1/18/12 Jennifer Tarantino was inside apartment E1N at 3034 Grand Concourse, Bronx, NY. She was visiting her boyfriend who was renting out the spare bedroom to another individual. Around 10:00 p.m. Ms. Tarantino was awoken by a loud noise and several police officers were pointing their guns at her as she lie in bed. Even though Ms. Tarantino was not a leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to the apartment she, as an overnight guest, was arrested and charged with possession of a controlled substance in the third degree. She was never presented with a search warrant despite numerous requests and never saw anything illegal in plain view. All charges against her were eventually dismissed.

h. On 11/18/11 Sabrina Souffront was in apartment 4A located at 1465 Washington Ave, Bronx, NY. Ms. Souffront was visiting a friend and was not a leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to said apartment. No contraband was ever in plain view and she had no knowledge of any contraband within the apartment. In the early morning hours, Ms. Souffront heard a loud bang at the front door and several police officers rushed into the apartment and detained all of the occupants. Ms. Souffront later learned that in one of the bedrooms, within a

closet, was a small amount of narcotics. Ms. Souffront was completely unaware of the existence of anything illegal in the apartment and in fact was never even in that particular bedroom during her visit. She was arrested and held in jail for over 24 hours. Eventually all charges against her were dismissed.

i. On 7/29/11 Ismael Velez and Michael Concepcion were inside the basement apartment at 512 East 162nd Street, Bronx, NY. The basement apartment was a music studio and Velez and Concepcion were recording. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden, several police officers rushed into the studio and assaulted Velez and Concepcion and arrested them for possession of marihuana. Velez and Concepcion were not leaseholders and had no legal ties to the basement apartment. In addition, Velez and Concepcion never saw any illegal substances in plain view at anytime they were in the recording studio. All charges were eventually dismissed.

j. On 6/17/10 Samantha Morales was inside apartment 5B located at 1000 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales and all of the occupants. Ms. Morales was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with possession of marihuana even though marihuana was never found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute Ms. Morales.

k. On 6/16/10 Coty Morales was inside apartment 4K at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Morales is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite

numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

l. On 6/16/10 Christopher Hernandez was inside apartment 4H at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Hernandez is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

m. On 2/1/12 Hector Figueroa, Sr., Hector Figueroa, Jr. and Laurita Figueroa were inside apartment 6A at 360 Morris Avenue, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours they heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. The police broke Mr. Figueroa, Sr.'s nose (he is approximately 74 years old). All were arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment and in point of fact no contraband was ever in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

n. On 2/28/14, Damario Morales and Robert Lopez, Jr., were exiting the basement apartment of 766 Union Avenue when all of a sudden several police officers rushed towards them and pushed and pulled them into the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales, Mr. Lopez and all of the occupants of the basement apartment. Neither Ms. Morales nor Mr. Lopez were the leaseholder of the apartment. Both were charged with possession of a controlled substance even though no narcotics were ever found and certainly none were in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually

dismissed both cases.

o. On 7/16/15 Fantasia Jenkins was inside apartment 8D located at 595 Trinity Avenue, Bronx, NY. Ms. Jenkins was simply an overnight guest in the apartment. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Ms. Jenkins and all of the occupants. Ms. Jenkins was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Ms. Jenkins spent 9 days in custody. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed Ms. Jenkins' case.

p. On 11/20/14 Jamel McNeil and Magan Paulino were inside a757 St. Anns Avenue, Bronx, NY. Both Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino were simply overnight guests in the house. In the late morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the house and arrested Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino and all of the occupants. Mr. McNeil nor Ms. Paulino were leaseholders, owners or renters of the house but only overnight guests. They were charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed both cases.

224. As is evidenced from the above, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR'S** injuries including the violation of his constitutional rights, the deprivation of his freedom, falsely and maliciously being prosecuted, physical and emotional injuries, are the direct and proximate result of the CITY'S and NYPD'S policies and/or deliberate indifference to practices which involve the excessive use of force, false arrest, police cover-ups, witness intimidation, malicious prosecution, illegal stop, questions and frisks, strip searches, Fourth Amendment violations, and deliberate

indifference to the need to train, supervise, monitor, investigate and discipline, including suspension, dismissal and/or reassignment offending police officers.

225. Moreover, it is the direct result of police officers arresting individuals for possession of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder. The practice is widespread and pervasive throughout the entire City of New York.

226. The CITY and NYPD knew or should have known of the customs and police practices of its officers which included but was not limited to: the failing to preserve and/or destruction of exculpatory evidence, threatening to arrest witnesses to police misconduct and engaging in cover-ups, fraud, perjury, deceit and malfeasance, arresting individuals when not in possession of a valid search warrant as well as police officers arresting individuals for possession of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder.

227. That the acts of employees of the CITY and NYPD, i.e. police officers, who violate the civil and constitutional rights of the citizens of the City of New York routinely go unreported, undisciplined and their acts condoned by other officers, including their supervisors. Upon information and belief, the supervisors of defendant police officers herein were aware of the conduct of defendant police officers and failed to stop, report or intervene in the misconduct.

228. The CITY and NYPD'S tolerance for brutality, excessive force, illegal and/or

retaliatory arrests, and their emphasis to come down hard on quality of life infractions leads to a systemic practice and policy wherein police officers seem fairly tolerant of police brutality, silence in the face of brutality and/or illegal stops, frisks, searches, seizures and/or arrests, and engage in the practice of meeting arrest quotas. A systemic practice where officers who report said misconduct are not viewed as “good cops” but rather as outcasts and are ostracized and often transferred to other assignments thereby perpetuating the illegal conduct of the NYPD and thusly the CITY.

229. Some instances where officers were treated as outcasts for reporting misconduct and/or arrest/summons quota system are as follows:

a. The existence of arrest quotas, summons quotas and approval of illegal stops and arrests have been exposed by Police officer Adrian Schoolcraft in a separate lawsuit which was cited by Justice Sheindlin in Floyd.

b. Justice Sheindlin referenced the deposition of Police Officer Polanco of the 41st Precinct stating that commanding officers set specific quotas for arrests and summons and for stop and frisks and threatened to reduce overtime for officers who failed to perform well and re-assign those who fail to meet quotas to less desirable posts.

c. According to secretly tape recorded conversations made by Schoolcraft, a Lieutenant, a Deputy Inspector and Chief of Transportation can be heard encouraging and demanding increased stops, summons and detentions and arrests.

d. Police Officer Craig Kathleens of the 42nd Precinct filed a lawsuit against the NYPD claiming the existence of a quota system and a systematic retaliation and harassment to those who did not comply.

e. Retired Detective James Griffin filed a lawsuit claiming that in the NYPD there

exists a culture wherein officers who report corruption will face harassment and a hostile work environment and that this conduct was tolerated by supervisors within the NYPD.

f. Police Officer Anthony Minoia, an officer with an Ivy League degree, assigned to the 42nd Precinct, was reassigned to a “punishment post” due to the fact that he failed to write a sufficient amount of summons and stated “I’m not going to pull out my summons book and write a summons because my boss is telling me he’s going to make it difficult for me if I don’t.”

230. In sum, the CITY and NYPD are responsible for creating a custom, policy or practice wherein many officers do not seem to believe that anything is really wrong with stopping and searching innocent citizens or using unnecessary or excessive force or falsely arresting citizens to meet an arrest quota.

231. That the above customs, policies and/or practices and the deliberate indifference thereto, was a direct and proximate cause of the illegal seizure of Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR**, the excessive use of force on Plaintiff, and the false arrest and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff. The CITY and NYPD’S policies, customs and/or practices deprived the Plaintiff of his rights and liberties as set forth in the Constitutions of the United States and the State of New York and under 42 U.S.C §§ 1983, 1986 and 1988.

232. That said actions violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, violated Plaintiff’s right to be secure in person, and that the defendants used excessive, unnecessary and unlawful force, which constituted cruel and inhumane treatment and denied him due process of law.

233. Moreover, the CITY and NYPD caused or created a policy and/or custom, and acted with deliberate indifference to patterns and/or police practices which included illegal seizures, excessive or arbitrary use of force, illegal use of police equipment, destruction of

evidence, intimidation of witnesses, illegal arrests, failing to gather evidence when allegations of police misconduct are involved, condoning a code of silence within the NYPD regarding misconduct, failing to take police reports of illegal conduct, failing to properly supervise, train, investigate or discipline officers, and any and/or all of the above have contributed to Plaintiff's false arrest, malicious and false prosecution, and injuries.

234. That the Plaintiff did not commit any illegal act, either before or at the time he was falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted, battered and deprived of his constitutional rights as set forth in the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C § 1983.

235. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF ANTHONY AYBAR**

236. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 235 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

237. At all times mentioned herein and above, defendants CITY and NYPD employed BASSAT, DOE and ROE as police officers and named defendants were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

238. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Bronx County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section

1988.

239. That on or about 1/15/18, defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and strip searched and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

240. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE resulted in Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process; and g) The right to Due Process of Law.

241. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, monitor, supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

242. Defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE subjected Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional,

grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR'S** rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the United States Constitution.

243 The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

244. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF EDMOND MARTINEZ**

245. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 244 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

246. That at all times the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was and is a resident of County of the Bronx, City and State of New York.

247. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York and doing nothing illegal, improper or acting suspicious in anyway. In point of fact, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was not in possession of any contraband on his person, no contraband was in plain view and Plaintiff was entirely unaware of any contraband on the premises if there were was indeed any at all (which there was not). Moreover, Plaintiff was not the leaseholder nor a resident of any apartment within 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx.

248. That on 1/15/18, at approximately, 1:30 p.m., in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, State of New York, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, absent an arrest warrant, probable cause, reasonable cause or any legal justification, approached Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** for no reason and summarily stopped, frisked, searched, grabbed, assaulted, battered, and detained him in an aggressive and excessive manner.

249. Upon information and belief BASSAT, DOE and ROE knew or had reason to know that their actions lacked any legal justification in approaching, searching, seizing and arresting Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ**.

250. Upon information and belief, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was subjected to a strip search while in the custody of defendants without any legal reason or justification.

251. That Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was arraigned after his arrest and thereafter falsely and maliciously prosecuted with committing a crime or crimes.

252. Thereafter, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** remained incarcerated for over 24 hours and was required to make numerous court appearances over an extended period of time until all charges against him were terminated favorably.

253. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** sustained physical and emotional pain and injuries as a result of this incident.

254. That within ninety (90) days after the causes of actions accrued herein, and more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** caused the notice of claim, in writing, sworn to by and on behalf of the claimants, the Plaintiff herein, containing the statement of the name and place of residence of the claimants by the street and number and their attorney, and describing the time when the particular claim and circumstances under which the damages and injuries were sustained, the cause thereof, and

so far as practical, the nature and extent of the injuries to be personally served upon the defendant CITY, their agents, servants and/or employees at the Law Department.

255. This action was so commenced within one (1) year and ninety (90) days after said cause of action accrued herein, and for more than thirty (30) days prior to the commencement of this action, defendant CITY neglected, refused and failed to make an adjustment of said claim, and said claim remains unadjusted and unpaid, although plaintiff herein has requested and demanded that the same be paid and adjusted.

256. That the defendants requested an oral examination pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H and same was held.

257. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, and with reckless, negligent and callous disregard for the truth, and without investigation, touched, grabbed, handcuffed, seized and arrested in an excessive manner and with excessive force by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, and in particular, by BASSAT, DOE and ROE.

258. That on or about 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** while lawfully in the vicinity of 1019 Simpson Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, was without just cause, probable cause or provocation, maliciously, intentionally and falsely accused by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE of having committed a crime or crimes.

259. That on or about 1/15/18, and upon arresting the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** and depriving him of his liberty, CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE took the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** to a police station in the County of Bronx and entered

him on the records as under arrest.

260. That on or about 1/15/18, the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE further caused Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** to have his fingerprints and photographs to be taken without his consent and in accordance with police procedures for the arrest of criminals and held him on various criminal charges at various police stations, correctional facilities and at the Courthouse located at 215 East 161st Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York.

261. That on or about 1/15/18 Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was aware of his arrest and confinement, he did not consent to his arrest or confinement, and said confinement, seizure, arrest and detention was without legal justification.

262. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

263. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TWENTY-THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF EDMOND MARTINEZ

264. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 263 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

265. That on or about 1/15/18, a criminal complaint was issued by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and based on fraud, perjury and misrepresentations.

266. That on or about 1/15/18 a criminal action against Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was commenced by CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and/or employees, without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification.

267. That solely as a result of the aforesaid, the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ'S** life was interfered with.

268. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was continued for an extended period of time by defendants with malice and bad faith.

269. That solely as a result of the false arrest, assault, battery, false imprisonment and malicious prosecution of the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ**, he was deprived of his liberty for an extended period of time and was subjected to scorn, ridicule, embarrassment and was degraded in the esteem of the community both personally and professionally.

270. That the criminal action against Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was terminated favorably by dismissal.

271. That the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

272. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF EDMOND MARTINEZ**

273. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 – 272 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

274. That on or about 1/15/18, and while in the custody of the defendants in the County of Bronx, City of New York, the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was intentionally touched, pushed, assaulted, battered, violated, strip searched, humiliated, photographed and handcuffed by the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority in such a manner as to knowingly cause injury to plaintiff.

275. That on or about 1/15/18 CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, their agents, servants and employees, acting as agents and on behalf of the CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE, within the scope of their employment, did intentionally, willfully and maliciously assault and batter the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** in that they have the real or apparent ability to cause imminent harmful and/or offensive bodily contact and intentionally did a violent and/or menacing act which threatened such contact to the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** and their act caused apprehension of such contact in the plaintiff, and in a hostile and/or offensive manner touched and beat the plaintiff and/or offensive bodily contact to the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** and caused such battery in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs.

276. That by reason of the aforesaid intentional assault and battery which was committed in an excessive manner and with excessive force and without legal justification or privilege by the defendants, their agents, servants and employees, who were acting within the scope of their employment and authority and without any probable or reasonable cause, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** suffered great and permanent bodily injury in and about his head, neck, back, body and limbs and was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled, and suffered conscious pain and suffering, and that she was otherwise damaged.

277. That as a result of the aforesaid assault and battery the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was caused to sustain serious, severe, painful and permanent bodily injuries so that

she was rendered sick, sore, lame and disabled and so remains and was and will be compelled to seek medical aid and attention and incur expenses for same in an endeavor to cure himself of his said injuries and she was and will be prevented from attending his usual occupation and duties.

278. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

279. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TWENTY- FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF EDMOND MARTINEZ

280. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 –279 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

281. That the CITY, NYPD, their agents, servants and employees were negligent, careless and reckless in hiring, retaining, training, monitoring, retraining, supervising and promoting its employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, in that said police officers, as employees of CITY and NYPD, were not qualified to be hired or retained or promoted as police officers, lacked the experience, skill, training and ability to be employed, retained and utilized in the manner that each was employed by CITY and NYPD.

282. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately test, analyze test results, and/or investigate above mentioned police officers backgrounds and performances.

283. That the CITY and NYPD failed to exercise due care and caution in its hiring, retaining, training and/or promoting practices in that CITY and NYPD failed to adequately screen said police officers, failed to adequately monitor said police officers, and failed to adequately discipline said police officers when they violate Patrol Guidelines.

284. Defendant CITY and NYPD were also negligent in that prior to and at the time of the acts complained of herein, due to the prior history of the police officer defendants named herein, knew or should have known of the bad disposition of said defendants, or at the very least had knowledge of facts that would put a reasonably prudent employer on inquiry concerning their bad disposition and the fact that defendant police officers were not suitable to be hired and employed by the CITY and NYPD and that due to their lack of training, these officers should have had adequate supervision so that they would not arrest innocent individuals nor use excessive force during the arrest process.

285. That by reason of the above, the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was injured in mind and body as he was arrested, prosecuted and rendered sick, sore, and damaged.

286. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

287. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TWENTY- SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF EDMOND MARTINEZ

288. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1-288 with the same force and effect as if fully set

forth at length herein.

289. In arresting Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ**, police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, were motivated by an ulterior purpose to do harm, without justification or economic or social excuse.

290. In arresting Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ**, police officers including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, acting in their capacity as agents, servants and employees of CITY and NYPD, sought either a detriment to Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** or a collateral advantage to the CITY and NYPD that is outside the legitimate ends of effectuating an arrest.

291. As a result of the abuse of process by defendants herein, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** sustained multiple injuries including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional distress, humiliation, loss of enjoyment of life, and fear and intimidation for his safety.

292. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the actions of CITY, NYPD and all defendants herein as described above were carried out in a reckless, deliberate, willful, wanton, malicious and grossly negligent manner.

293. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

**AS AND FOR A TWENTY-SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF EDMOND MARTINEZ**

294. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 293 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

295. That on 1/15/18, at approximately 1:30 p.m., within the vicinity of 1019 Simpson

Street, County of Bronx, City and State of New York, the CITY and NYPD were present through its agents, servants and/or employees including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE who were acting in the course of their employment and under the color of law to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

296. The CITY and NYPD on a consistent and constant basis, have a policy or a program, whether implicit or explicit, that its' agents, employees and others acting under the direction of defendants including but not limited to BASSAT, DOE and ROE, with or without a valid search warrant, with or without lawful entry onto private real property or a premises such as an apartment, unlawfully detain, harass, seize, search, destroy and illegally remove personal property and thereafter arrest individuals within such a premises who are neither leaseholders nor owners of said premises (as herein) and who are only present in a room on said real property where contraband is not in plain view.

297. The above must be considered, as the facts herein suggest, when an individual is in a room on a premises where contraband is not in plain view, it cannot be said, as a matter of law, that said individual is to be in actual or constructive possession of contraband nor in possession pursuant to a Penal Law statutory presumption. Nonetheless, defendants on a consistent and constant basis unlawfully stop, seize, search and arrest individuals, such as the Plaintiff herein, in such a scenario even though the stop, seizure and arrest of said individual, including Plaintiff herein, is lacking in reasonable cause, probable cause or legal justification.

298. The foregoing acts, omissions and systemic failures are customs and policies of the CITY and NYPD which caused the police officers herein to falsely arrest, maliciously prosecute, illegally seize and search the Plaintiff unlawfully, commit an assault and battery to Plaintiff's

person under the belief that said police officers would not suffer any disciplinary actions for their improper and unconstitutional conduct.

299. The CITY and NYPD'S failure to train its police officers to distinguish between individuals who are lessee's and/or reside at a premises for a sufficient length of time as evidenced by utility bills in their name, letters or mail addressed to them at the premises, as opposed to individuals who are mere guests or visitors who do not have the right to exercise dominion and control over the premises as evidenced by their not having any furniture in the premises, their name on the lease, their name on a utility bill or mail addressed to them as well as having no personal belongings within the premises that demonstrate something more than a temporary or overnight guest, are all factors that the CITY and NYPD have consistently and constantly ignored in a deliberate and malicious fashion.

300. As the same fact patterns are present over the past several years with alarming frequency, it is apparent and obvious that a pattern by the CITY and NYPD has developed and is in place demonstrating continued violations of individuals similarly situated to the Plaintiff herein. The pattern demonstrates either a defacto policy or custom that exists to allow this behavior by failing to discipline its officers or that this is a custom of its police officers who have no and/or insufficient training and/or no proper supervision and/or disciplinary penalties assessed against them for continued acting in an unconstitutional manner.

301. The below examples demonstrate a small sample of the pattern practice and custom of deliberate indifference by the CITY and NYPD by arresting innocent individuals who are merely present in a location when contraband is not in plain view and have no legal ties to the premises being searched either with or without a search warrant, either legally or illegally.

a. On 10/22/10, Joanne BROWN, Andrea Doby and Tameka Gunter were inside

apartment 4E at 1684 Nelson Avenue, Bronx, NY. They were doing nothing illegal or improper and were simply visiting a friend. None of the aforementioned individuals were leaseholders or had any legal connections to the premises. All 3 individuals were only in the apartment for a short while when all of a sudden several police officers entered the apartment and arrested all of the occupants. Despite several requests the officers never presented a search warrant. All 3 of the above-mentioned individuals were charged with possession of a controlled substance in the seventh degree despite the fact that none of them ever were aware of or had any knowledge of any contraband in the apartment and contraband was not in plain view at anytime. All charges were eventually dismissed.

b. On 2/8/08, Tony Mizell was inside apartment 2 at 950 Saint John Avenue, Bronx, NY. Mr. Mizell was not a leaseholder of said premises and had no legal connection to the apartment. He was simply an overnight guest with his wife and small child. All of a sudden, in the early morning hours, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested all of the occupants for possession of a weapon. A search warrant was never presented. The weapon was located in a back bedroom inside a closet within a coat pocket. Mr. Mizell had no connection to the gun, the bedroom or the closet. He was arrested and prosecuted for several months even though the owner of the gun pled guilty in Federal Court shortly after 2/8/08. Eventually all charges were dismissed against Mr. Mizell.

c. On 1/10/10 Gregory Jacobus was inside apartment 4 located at 2290 Davidson Avenue, Bronx, New York. Mr. Jacobus was visiting his chess teacher. He was simply an overnight guest in apartment 4 and was not a leaseholder and had no legal rights to the apartment. Early in the morning while Mr. Jacobus was in the shower, several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Mr. Jacobus and his chess teacher. A search warrant was

never presented. Mr. Jacobus never saw any contraband in the apartment at anytime and had no knowledge of any contraband if there was indeed any. After spending several days in jail, a Grand Jury dismissed all charges against Mr. Jacobus.

d. On 6/12/07 Joanne Reyes was inside apartment 1F at 1530 Sheridan Ave, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours Ms. Reyes heard a loud bang and several people rushed into her apartment. Ms. Reyes thought she was getting robbed until she realized the individuals were police officers. Even though Ms. Reyes was not a leaseholder to the apartment and no contraband was in plain view at anytime and Ms. Reyes never saw any contraband within the apartment at anytime, she was handcuffed, arrested and taken to a local precinct and then central booking. Her pleas for her medications were summarily ignored throughout the entire time she was detained. After being prosecuted for several months the case was eventually dismissed.

e. On 4/4/08 Shakenia Garlick was inside apartment 7B at 2487 Grand Avenue, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours several police officers broke down the front door and entered her apartment. No search warrant was ever presented. Ms. Garlick had no knowledge of any contraband in the apartment and same was never in plain view. Despite aggressive questioning by the officers Ms. Garlick insisted that they were making a mistake and were, perhaps, in the wrong apartment. She was arrested for possession of a controlled substance. The substance was her pre-natal vitamins. The case was dismissed by the District Attorney's Office when the laboratory analysis indicated negative for a controlled substance.

f. On 8/5/09 Edward Benitez was inside apartment 5E visiting his friend at 894 Rogers Place. It was the early afternoon and Mr. Benitez was inside the apartment for only a few minutes. All of a sudden there was a knock at the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Despite the fact that Mr. Benitez was not a resident of the apartment, not a

leaseholder and had no legal connection to the apartment he was arrested for possession of marihuana which was neither on his person or in plain view in any part of the apartment. After several court appearances all charges were dismissed against him

g. On 1/18/12 Jennifer Tarantino was inside apartment E1N at 3034 Grand Concourse, Bronx, NY. She was visiting her boyfriend who was renting out the spare bedroom to another individual. Around 10:00 p.m. Ms. Tarantino was awoken by a loud noise and several police officers were pointing their guns at her as she lie in bed. Even though Ms. Tarantino was not a leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to the apartment she, as an overnight guest, was arrested and charged with possession of a controlled substance in the third degree. She was never presented with a search warrant despite numerous requests and never saw anything illegal in plain view. All charges against her were eventually dismissed.

h. On 11/18/11 Sabrina Souffront was in apartment 4A located at 1465 Washington Ave, Bronx, NY. Ms. Souffront was visiting a friend and was not a leaseholder of the apartment and had no legal rights to said apartment. No contraband was ever in plain view and she had no knowledge of any contraband within the apartment. In the early morning hours, Ms. Souffront heard a loud bang at the front door and several police officers rushed into the apartment and detained all of the occupants. Ms. Souffront later learned that in one of the bedrooms, within a closet, was a small amount of narcotics. Ms. Souffront was completely unaware of the existence of anything illegal in the apartment and in fact was never even in that particular bedroom during her visit. She was arrested and held in jail for over 24 hours. Eventually all charges against her were dismissed.

i. On 7/29/11 Ismael Velez and Michael Concepcion were inside the basement apartment at 512 East 162nd Street, Bronx, NY. The basement apartment was a music studio and

Velez and Concepcion were recording. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden, several police officers rushed into the studio and assaulted Velez and Concepcion and arrested them for possession of marihuana. Velez and Concepcion were not leaseholders and had no legal ties to the basement apartment. In addition, Velez and Concepcion never saw any illegal substances in plain view at anytime they were in the recording studio. All charges were eventually dismissed.

j. On 6/17/10 Samantha Morales was inside apartment 5B located at 1000 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales and all of the occupants. Ms. Morales was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with possession of marihuana even though marihuana was never found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute Ms. Morales.

k. On 6/16/10 Coty Morales was inside apartment 4K at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Morales is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

l. On 6/16/10 Christopher Hernandez was inside apartment 4H at 995 Simpson Street, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours he heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. Mr. Hernandez is not a leaseholder of the apartment and has no legal rights to same. He was arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment. No search warrant was ever

presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

m. On 2/1/12 Hector Figueroa, Sr., Hector Figueroa, Jr. and Laurita Figueroa were inside apartment 6A at 360 Morris Avenue, Bronx, NY. In the early morning hours they heard a bang on the door and several police officers rushed into the apartment. The police broke Mr. Figueroa, Sr.'s nose (he is approximately 74 years old). All were arrested and charged with possession of marihuana despite the fact that nothing of an illegal nature was ever found in the apartment and in point of fact no contraband was ever in the apartment. No search warrant was ever presented despite numerous requests. The District Attorney's Office declined to prosecute the case.

n. On 2/28/14, Damario Morales and Robert Lopez, Jr., were exiting the basement apartment of 766 Union Avenue when all of a sudden several police officers rushed towards them and pushed and pulled them into the apartment and arrested Ms. Morales, Mr. Lopez and all of the occupants of the basement apartment. Neither Ms. Morales nor Mr. Lopez were the leaseholder of the apartment. Both were charged with possession of a controlled substance even though no narcotics were ever found and certainly none were in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed both cases.

o. On 7/16/15 Fantasia Jenkins was inside apartment 8D located at 595 Trinity Avenue, Bronx, NY. Ms. Jenkins was simply an overnight guest in the apartment. In the early morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the apartment and arrested Ms. Jenkins and all of the occupants. Ms. Jenkins was not a leaseholder of the apartment. She was charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found

and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Ms. Jenkins spent 9 days in custody. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed Ms. Jenkins' case.

p. On 11/20/14 Jamel McNeil and Magan Paulino were inside a757 St. Anns Avenue, Bronx, NY. Both Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino were simply overnight guests in the house. In the late morning hours, all of a sudden several police officers rushed into the house and arrested Mr. McNeil and Ms. Paulino and all of the occupants. Mr. McNeil nor Ms. Paulino were leaseholders, owners or renters of the house but only overnight guests. They were charged with criminal possession of a controlled substance even though narcotics were not found and certainly not in plain view at anytime. Despite requests a search warrant was never presented. The District Attorney's Office eventually dismissed both cases.

302. As is evidenced from the above, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ'S** injuries including the violation of his constitutional rights, the deprivation of his freedom, falsely and maliciously being prosecuted, physical and emotional injuries, are the direct and proximate result of the CITY'S and NYPD'S policies and/or deliberate indifference to practices which involve the excessive use of force, false arrest, police cover-ups, witness intimidation, malicious prosecution, illegal stop, questions and frisks, strip searches, Fourth Amendment violations, and deliberate indifference to the need to train, supervise, monitor, investigate and discipline, including suspension, dismissal and/or reassignment offending police officers.

303. Moreover, it is the direct result of police officers arresting individuals for possession of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the

individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder. The practice is widespread and pervasive throughout the entire City of New York.

304. The CITY and NYPD knew or should have known of the customs and police practices of its officers which included but was not limited to: the failing to preserve and/or destruction of exculpatory evidence, threatening to arrest witnesses to police misconduct and engaging in cover-ups, fraud, perjury, deceit and malfeasance, arresting individuals when not in possession of a valid search warrant as well as police officers arresting individuals for possession of contraband within a premises when either no such contraband exists or is not in plain view and the nexus between the contraband and the individual being arrested is so lacking that reasonable cause to effectuate the arrest is not present especially in light of the fact when the individual is only a temporary or overnight guest in the premises and is not the leaseholder.

305. That the acts of employees of the CITY and NYPD, i.e. police officers, who violate the civil and constitutional rights of the citizens of the City of New York routinely go unreported, undisciplined and their acts condoned by other officers, including their supervisors. Upon information and belief, the supervisors of defendant police officers herein were aware of the conduct of defendant police officers and failed to stop, report or intervene in the misconduct.

306. The CITY and NYPD'S tolerance for brutality, excessive force, illegal and/or retaliatory arrests, and their emphasis to come down hard on quality of life infractions leads to a systemic practice and policy wherein police officers seem fairly tolerant of police brutality, silence in the face of brutality and/or illegal stops, frisks, searches, seizures and/or arrests, and engage in the practice of meeting arrest quotas. A systemic practice where officers who report said misconduct are not viewed as "good cops" but rather as outcasts and are ostracized and often transferred to other assignments thereby perpetuating the illegal conduct of the NYPD and

thusly the CITY.

307. Some instances where officers were treated as outcasts for reporting misconduct and/or arrest/summons quota system are as follows:

a. The existence of arrest quotas, summons quotas and approval of illegal stops and arrests have been exposed by Police officer Adrian Schoolcraft in a separate lawsuit which was cited by Justice Sheindlin in Floyd.

b. Justice Sheindlin referenced the deposition of Police Officer Polanco of the 41st Precinct stating that commanding officers set specific quotas for arrests and summons and for stop and frisks and threatened to reduce overtime for officers who failed to perform well and re-assign those who fail to meet quotas to less desirable posts.

c. According to secretly tape recorded conversations made by Schoolcraft, a Lieutenant, a Deputy Inspector and Chief of Transportation can be heard encouraging and demanding increased stops, summons and detentions and arrests.

d. Police Officer Craig Kathleens of the 42nd Precinct filed a lawsuit against the NYPD claiming the existence of a quota system and a systematic retaliation and harassment to those who did not comply.

e. Retired Detective James Griffin filed a lawsuit claiming that in the NYPD there exists a culture wherein officers who report corruption will face harassment and a hostile work environment and that this conduct was tolerated by supervisors within the NYPD.

f. Police Officer Anthony Minoia, an officer with an Ivy League degree, assigned to the 42nd Precinct, was reassigned to a "punishment post" due to the fact that he failed to write a sufficient amount of summons and stated "I'm not going to pull out my summons book and write a summons because my boss is telling me he's going to make it difficult for me if I don't."

308. In sum, the CITY and NYPD are responsible for creating a custom, policy or practice wherein many officers do not seem to believe that anything is really wrong with stopping and searching innocent citizens or using unnecessary or excessive force or falsely arresting citizens to meet an arrest quota.

309. That the above customs, policies and/or practices and the deliberate indifference thereto, was a direct and proximate cause of the illegal seizure of Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ**, the excessive use of force on Plaintiff, and the false arrest and malicious prosecution of Plaintiff. The CITY and NYPD'S policies, customs and/or practices deprived the Plaintiff of his rights and liberties as set forth in the Constitutions of the United States and the State of New York and under 42 U.S.C §§ 1983, 1986 and 1988.

310. That said actions violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, violated Plaintiff's right to be secure in person, and that the defendants used excessive, unnecessary and unlawful force, which constituted cruel and inhumane treatment and denied him due process of law.

311. Moreover, the CITY and NYPD caused or created a policy and/or custom, and acted with deliberate indifference to patterns and/or police practices which included illegal seizures, excessive or arbitrary use of force, illegal use of police equipment, destruction of evidence, intimidation of witnesses, illegal arrests, failing to gather evidence when allegations of police misconduct are involved, condoning a code of silence within the NYPD regarding misconduct, failing to take police reports of illegal conduct, failing to properly supervise, train, investigate or discipline officers, and any and/or all of the above have contributed to Plaintiff's false arrest, malicious and false prosecution, and injuries.

312. That the Plaintiff did not commit any illegal act, either before or at the time he was

falsely arrested and imprisoned, assaulted, battered and deprived of his constitutional rights as set forth in the Constitution of the United States and 42 U.S.C § 1983.

313. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

AS AND FOR A TWENTY-EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION ON BEHALF OF
PLAINTIFF EDMOND MARTINEZ

314. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs numbered 1 - 313 with the same force and effect as if fully set forth at length herein.

315. At all times mentioned herein and above, defendants CITY and NYPD employed BASSAT, DOE and ROE as police officers and named defendants were acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances and regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

316. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** is and at all times relevant herein, a citizen of the United States and a resident of Bronx County in the State of New York and brings this cause of action pursuant to 42 United States Code, Section 1983 and 42 United States Code, Section 1988.

317. That on or about 1/15/18, defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE without probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification and while effectuating the seizure of plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ**, did search, seize, assault and commit a battery and grab the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** without a court authorized arrest warrant or search warrant and defendants did physically seize Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** during the arrest

process in an unlawful and excessive manner. Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and strip searched and as a result of defendants' conduct maliciously prosecuted without the defendants possessing probable cause, reasonable cause or legal justification to do so.

318. The above actions of defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE resulted in Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution: a) Freedom from assault to his person; b) Freedom from battery to his person; c) Freedom from illegal search and seizure; d) Freedom from false arrest; e) Freedom from malicious prosecution; f) Freedom from the use of excessive force during the arrest process; and g) The right to Due Process of Law.

319. In addition to the above, defendants CITY and NYPD have as a matter of policy, custom and practice and with deliberate indifference failed to adequately train, monitor, supervise, discipline, sanction or otherwise direct its police officers, including the officers involved in this case and any and all unnamed officers involved in the unlawful seizure and arrest of plaintiff, regarding the protection of the constitutional rights of citizens.

320. Defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE subjected Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** to such deprivation in a malicious, reckless, deliberate, intentional, grossly negligent and with a callous disregard of Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ'S** rights and with deliberate indifference to those rights under the Fourth, Fifth, Sixth, Fourteenth and all other related Amendments to the United States Constitution.

321. The direct and proximate result of the defendants CITY, NYPD, BASSAT, DOE and ROE acts are that Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has suffered severe and permanent injuries, loss of liberty and companionship, forced to endure pain and suffering, emotional

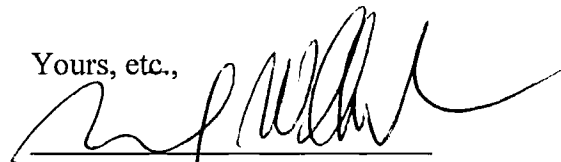
distress and severe and significant damage to standing and reputation in the community.

322. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** has been damaged in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state.

WHEREFORE, the Plaintiff **TAHA HAMZA** demands judgment against the defendants on the First Cause of Action through the Seventh Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, the Plaintiff **JAWAD AWAD** demands judgment against the defendants on the Eighth Cause of Action through the Fourteenth Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, the Plaintiff **ANTHONY AYBAR** demands judgment against the defendants on the Fifteenth Cause of Action through the Twenty-First Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, the Plaintiff **EDMOND MARTINEZ** demands judgment against the defendants on the Twenty-Second Cause of Action through the Twenty- Eighth Cause of Action in a sum that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower trial courts of this state for each cause of action, all together with attorney's fees, punitive damages and the costs and disbursements of this action

Dated: Bronx, New York
July 12, 2018

Yours, etc.,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Neil Wollerstein', written over a horizontal line.

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.

Attorney for Plaintiffs
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(718) 588-1300
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ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the courts of the State of New York affirms the following to be true pursuant to CPLR 2106 and under the penalties of perjury:

1. The undersigned, an attorney admitted to practice in the Courts of the State of New York states that he is retained on behalf of plaintiffs.
2. That affirmant has read the foregoing **SUMMONS and VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and knows the contents thereof; that the same is true to affirmant's own knowledge except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief; and that as to those matters affirmant believes them to be true.
3. Your affirmant further says that the reason this verification is made by affirmant and not the plaintiffs is that the plaintiffs are not currently available.

Dated: Bronx, New York
July 12, 2018


NEIL WOLLERSTEIN

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

TAHA HAMZA, JAWAD AWAD, ANTHONY AYBAR and EDMOND MARTINEZ,

Plaintiffs,

– against –

**CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, DETECTIVE JOE
BASSAT, POLICE OFFICER JOHN DOE AND POLICE OFFICER JOHN ROE,**

Defendant(s).

SUMMONS AND VERIFIED COMPLAINT

NEIL WOLLERSTEIN, ESQ.

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